



▲ MOSIN-NAGANT M91

Date 1891

Origin Imperial Russia

Barrel 31½in (80.2cm)

Caliber 7.62 × 54mm

The “3-line,” as it was called, was Imperial Russia’s first repeater rifle and its first in a modern caliber. The “line” was a measure approximating one-tenth of an inch and refers to its caliber.

▲ STEYR M1893
CAVALRY CARBINE

Date 1893

Origin Austria

Barrel 18in (46cm)

Caliber 6.5mm

The Austrian national arms factory, Steyr, produced 14,000 carbines of this design for Romania, which were delivered before the outbreak of World War I. Designed by Ferdinand Ritter von Mannlicher, they had a turning bolt, rather than Mannlicher’s straight-pull breech mechanism (see p.149), and a single-column five-round box magazine, loaded by clip.



▲ LEBEL MLE 1886/93

Date 1893

Origin France

Barrel 31½in (80cm)

Caliber 8 × 50mm

In 1885, Georges Boulanger was appointed to the ministry of war in Paris. One of his first priorities was to introduce a modern rifle. The result was the first rifle firing a small-caliber, jacketed bullet propelled by smokeless powder (invented by Meille in 1884.) Despite being mechanically unsophisticated, it rendered every other rifle in the world obsolete. This modified version followed in 1893.